

Now that you know how Twitter can be used, here's how to set it up. Go to www.twitter.com and sign up. You will receive a unique URL—<http://www.twitter/username/>. Log in using your username and password and search e-mail services like Gmail, Yahoo!, MSN and AOL for your contacts. All those who are twitter members will show up in the list and you will be able to add them to your follow list. There is an option to invite other people by using their e-mail addresses. Once you have found the people who you like to follow and have added them, sit back and follow their updates. Privacy options include the feature to block a particular person from following your updates and to keep your posts out of public viewing. You can send private messages to others on your list by clicking on their names. Similarly, you can also get private messages from others.

Twitter can be tied in with IM and SMS facilities to provide great functionality. Go to Settings > Phone & IM and enter your IM screen name and phone number. In both cases you will be given a confirmation code. After following the instructions given, you



Configuring Twitter for IM and phone

can keep an eye out for updates from people on your list. In case of phones, you need to verify your number by messaging the code to a specified number. Once that is done, you can post and receive tweets via your mobile.

One of Twitter's greatest advantages is the proliferation of Twitter widgets. These widgets increase the available functionality, making it more user-friendly and following updates a lot less complicated. For an exhaustive list of such applications go to <http://twitter.com/downloads> and check out the wide variety of downloadable Twitter widgets made by third party developers.



The Facebook application for Twitter